A BOLDER WORLD
THROUGH BIGGER IDEAS

HULT PRIZE 2026-27

THEME 2026

A DECADE OF IMPACT

UNLEASHING A NEW GENERATION OF SOLUTIONS FOR A BRIGHTER, FAIRER TOMORROW.

- INNOVATION
- ENTREPRENEURSHIP
- SOCIAL IMPACT

OFFICIAL WEBSITE

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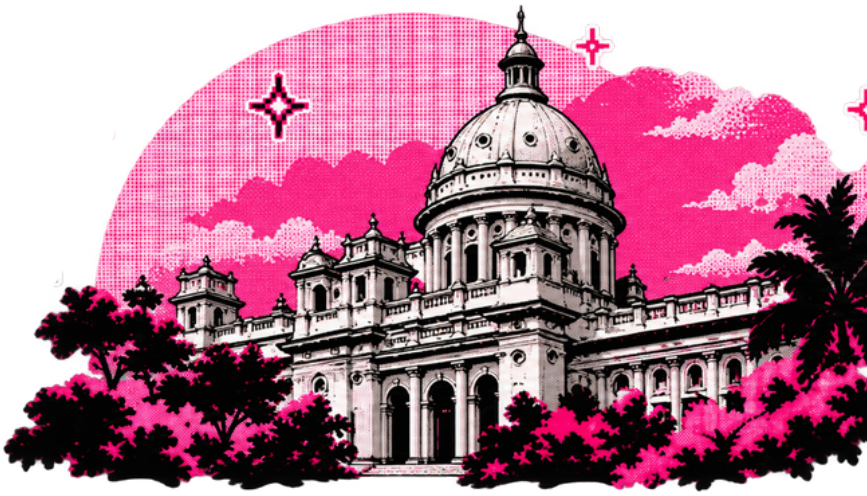
IDEAS TODAY.
A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.



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ABOUT UNIVERSITY OF CALCUTTA

Founded in1857, theUniversity of Calcutta stands as one of India's oldest and most prestigious centers of higher learning, shaping generations of leaders, reformers, and pioneers. Accredited with an "A" grade by the NAAC and ranked among the nation's leading state public universities, it has been at the forefront of intellectual and social transformation for over a century and a half.

The University's legacy is deeply interwoven with the story of modern India and Asia, its corridors have nurtured, and its academic community has been associated with, six Nobel laureates, Fellows of the Royal Society, Bhatnagar Awardees, the only Indian recipient of the Dirac Medal, and a host of visionaries who went on to become heads of state, government leaders, social reformers, renowned artists, and countless celebrated figures across the world. With such an illustrious past, the University of Calcutta continues to be a beacon of knowledge, innovation, and cultural heritage, inspiring future generations to carry forward its tradition of excellence.

NIRF RANKING 2025

In the 2025 NIRF rankings, the University was ranked 47th overall, 48th in research, 39th among universities, and 3rd in West Bengal as a University.

ASIA UNIVERSITY RANKINGS 2025

In the 2025 QS Asian University Rankings, the University was ranked between 771-780.

BRIEF ABOUT HULT PRIZE

Hult Prize University of Calcutta

HULT PRIZE IS A GLOBALCOMPETITION AND THE LARGEST NETWORK OF UNIVERSITY HUBS, EMPOWERING STUDENTS TO CREATE SOLUTIONS FOR GLOBAL CHALLENGES.

HULT PRIZE OFFERS A US $1,000,000 STARTUP PRIZE. IT INSPIRES YOUNG INNOVATORS TO TURN IDEAS INTO SCALABLE VENTURES FOR A BETTER FUTURE.

ON CAMPUS PROGRAMES CONNECTS 2,000+ CAMPUSES GLOBALLY, FOSTERING INNOVATION AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP TO SUPPORT THE UN'S SDGS AND SOsocietal GOOD.

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HULT PRIZE 2026-27

The 2026 Challenge

"UNLEASH A NEW GENERATION OF SOLUTIONS FOR A BRIGHTER, FAIRER TOMORROW."

The Hult Prize 2026 calls on young changemakers to build bold, people-centered solutions that tackle the world's most pressing challenges and create a more inclusive, equitable and sustainable future for all.

What Are We Looking For?

We are looking for innovative, scalable and impact driven ideas or early stage ventures that address real world challenges. Participants are expected to develop solutions that are people centered, financially viable and capable of creating measurable, long term impact.

Key Focus Areas

INNOVATION
Bold ideas for real-world challenges

ENTREPRENEURSHIP
Turning ideas into sustainable ventures

SUSTAINABILITY
Solutions for a healthier planet

SCALABILITY
Models that can grow and create wider impact

SOCIAL IMPACT
Building a fairer, more inclusive world

What Makes Hult Prize 2026 Different?

GLOBAL PLATFORM FOR CHANGE
Be part of the world's largest student movement for social impact, with access to an international network of changemakers, mentors and leaders.

REAL-WORLD OPPORTUNITIES
Gain access to funding, incubation, and global exposure to take your idea from campus to the world stage.

A DECADE OF IMPACT
Join a legacy of 10+ years of empowering young people to solve the world's most pressing challenges.

PEOPLE-CENTERED SOLUTIONS
This year's challenge puts people, equity and inclusion at the heart of innovation — building solutions for a brighter, fairer tomorrow.

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ABOUT INSTITUTION'S INNOVATION COUNCIL (IIC)

What is IIC?

The Institution's Innovation Council (IIC) is a platform that promotes innovation, creativity, research and entrepreneurship among students.

It helps students transform their ideas into practical solutions and impactful ventures through mentoring, workshops and innovation activities.

IIC at University of Calcutta

The Institution's Innovation Council (IIC) at the University of Calcutta promotes innovation, research and entrepreneurship, helping students turn ideas into practical solutions with real-world impact. It strives to create a vibrant innovation ecosystem on campus by connecting students with mentors, industry experts and opportunities across diverse disciplines.

OUR OBJECTIVES

- Promote innovation & creativity
- Encourage startups & entrepreneurship
- Support interdisciplinary collaboration
- Provide mentorship & industry connections
- Turn ideas into practical solutions

IIC's Key Activities

- Ideation and innovation programmes
- Entrepreneurship & startup awareness
- Workshops, seminars and mentoring
- Hackathons and innovation challenges
- Research and prototype development
- Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) awareness
- Industry and academic interactions
- Incubation and startup support

IIC & Student Innovation

IIC provides students with a platform to identify problems, develop ideas and turn them into practical solutions. Through mentoring, workshops, hackathons, research activities and industry interaction, students gain experience in innovation, problem-solving and entrepreneurship. It empowers young minds to think beyond boundaries and create solutions for real-world challenges.

WHY PARTICIPATE

Participate in the Hult Prize to learn, innovate, build, collaborate, connect, and create impact. Develop entrepreneurial skills, turn your ideas into real-world solutions, work with diverse teams, connect with mentors and industry leaders, and pitch your venture on a global platform.

ELIGIBILTY CRITERIA

1. Student Eligibility

- Participants must be at least 18 years of age by 28 February 2027.
- Participants must be currently enrolled in a degree seeking programme at a recognised university or college.
- Both undergraduate and postgraduate students are eligible to participate.

2. Team Composition

- Each team must consist of 2 to 4 students.
- Each participant may register with only one team.
- Each team will develop and present one business/startup idea.
- A team representsone university for the competition.

3. Business / Startup Eligibility

- The proposed venture must be a for-profit business or startup.
- The business idea must contribute directly to addressing at least one United Nations Sustainable Development Goal (UN SDG).
- Teams may participate with:
  - An early-stage business idea
  - A prototype
  - An existing startup
  - An operational venture
- There is no requirement for a team to have previously received funding.

4. Organisational Eligibility

Participants involved in organising the respective On-Campus programme may be subject to restrictions on competing in the same campus programme, in accordance with Hult Prize's official rules.

5. Important Note

All participating teams must comply with the official Hult Prize rules, regulations, Terms & Conditions, and eligibility requirements applicable to the 2026–27 competition cycle. In case of any discrepancy, the official Hult Prize regulations shall prevail.

HULT PRIZE 2026-27

EVALUATION CRITERIA

TEAM

Can the team execute its vision?

- Team commitment
- Complementary skills
- Clear roles and responsibilities
- Collaboration and leadership
- Ability to work effectively together

IDEA

Does the solution address a genuine and well-understood problem?

- Understanding of the problem
- Relevance of the proposed solution
- Innovation
- Practicality
- Potential and clarity of the concept

IMPACT

Can the venture create meaningful and measurable impact?

- Alignment with at least one UN SDG
- Significance of the problem addressed
- Potential social or environmental impact
- Measurable impact
- Contribution toward the SDG agenda

BUSSINESS VIABILITY

Can the idea become a sustainable business?

- Business model
- Revenue potential
- Market opportunity
- Customer need
- Financial and operational sustainability
- Potential for growth

As the venture progresses

PROGRESSION AREA	CORE QUESTION
Product-Market Fit	Does the solution demonstrably address a real market need?
Go-to-Market Strategy	Does the team have a credible plan to reach and acquire customers?
Traction	Is there evidence that the venture is gaining users, customers, partnerships or other meaningful validation?
Scaling	Can the business model and impact be expanded sustainably?

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FUELING DREAMS

WHERE IDEAS MEET GLOBAL CHANGE

It is my privilege to welcome you to the Hult Prize On Campus 2026–27 at the University of Calcutta, a platform for innovation, entrepreneurship, and social responsibility.

Aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, the Hult Prize encourages students to identify pressing challenges, develop meaningful solutions, and transform ideas into ventures with lasting impact.

At the University of Calcutta, this initiative builds on our tradition of academic excellence and intellectual inquiry by creating an ecosystem where student ideas can be explored, refined, mentored, and developed into purposeful ventures.

I invite students across the University to embrace this opportunity as a journey of collaboration, learning, and impact. With determination, mentorship, and the right platform, a simple observation can become a solution that creates meaningful change.

Let us come together to innovate and create with purpose.

Ashmit
Campus Director
Hult Prize On-Campus 2026–27
University of Calcutta

Empowering Visionaries

BUILDING TOMORROW TOGETHER

Dear Hult Prize Community,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you all to the Hult Prize at the University of Calcutta for the 2025–26 season.

As we embark on this journey, I encourage each one of you to bring your ideas, creativity, and passion to the table. Hult Prize is more than just a competition—it is a platform to turn meaningful ideas into solutions that can create real impact.

Let's collaborate, challenge ourselves, learn from one another, and make this season a memorable one. I look forward to witnessing the ideas you build and the change you inspire.

Let's dream, create, and make an impact together.

Best Wishes,
Diksha
Deputy Campus Director
Hult Prize at University of Calcutta

Igniting Action

TRANSFORMING POTENTIAL INTO IMPACT

Hey everyone!

A very warm welcome to Hult Prize at University of Calcutta 2026–27!

Hult Prize is so much more than a business competition, it is a launchpad for young innovators, thinkers, and changemakers. It gives you the platform to take your boldest ideas and transform them into real-world, sustainable ventures that tackle pressing global challenges.

Whether you are stepping up to build a startup from scratch, solve critical social issues, or simply push yourself out of your comfort zone, this journey will challenge you to think bigger and reach further.

Our team is here to support, guide, and champion you every step of the way. Bring your vision, bring your passion, and let's create something truly extraordinary together!

Warmly,
Deblina Biswas
Deputy Campus Director,
Hult Prize at University of Calcutta

FACULTY COORDINATORS

Prof. Swapan Kumar Ghosh

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you to the Hult Prize, a platform that encourages young minds to think boldly, innovate purposefully, and create solutions to some of the world's most pressing challenges.

As an institution, we believe that education extends beyond classrooms. Opportunities such as the Hult Prize inspire students to transform their ideas into meaningful action, develop an entrepreneurial mindset, and create a positive impact on society.

I encourage all participants to embrace this journey with curiosity, courage, and determination. Let your ideas be driven not only by innovation but also by empathy, sustainability, and a commitment to making a difference.

I extend my best wishes to all the participants and the organising team. May this initiative inspire new ideas, nurture future leaders, and pave the way for a better tomorrow.

Teacher-in-charge Hult Prize On-Campus, University of Calcutta

skgjft@caluniv.ac.in

Dr. Shampa Guin

It is a privilege to be a part of the Hult Prize, an initiative that inspires young minds to turn innovative ideas into meaningful solutions for real-world challenges.

The Institution's Innovation Council (IIC) is committed to fostering a culture of innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship, and problem-solving among students. The Hult Prize provides an excellent platform for students to explore their ideas, collaborate with like-minded individuals, and develop solutions that can create sustainable social impact.

I encourage all participants to approach this journey with an open mind, a spirit of collaboration, and the courage to think differently. Every idea has the potential to make a difference when driven by purpose and perseverance.

I extend my best wishes to all the participants and the organising team for a successful and inspiring Hult Prize journey. May this initiative empower our students to become innovative thinkers, responsible entrepreneurs, and changemakers of tomorrow.

IIC Coordinator Hult Prize & Campus Co-ordinator of Rajabazar Science College Campus

sgrpe@caluniv.ac.in

FACULTY COORDINATORS

Dr. Rajarshi Gupta

It is a matter of great pleasure to welcome you to the Hult Prize, a remarkable platform that encourages young minds to transform innovative ideas into solutions that can create meaningful social impact.

The Institution's Innovation Council (IIC) is committed to nurturing a culture of innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship, and responsible problem-solving among students. The Hult Prize provides an excellent opportunity for our students to think beyond conventional boundaries, collaborate across disciplines, and develop ideas with the potential to address real-world challenges.

I encourage every participant to embrace this journey with curiosity, courage, and perseverance. Let your ideas be guided by purpose, strengthened through collaboration, and translated into action.

I extend my sincere appreciation to the organising team, mentors, and participants for their enthusiasm and commitment. I wish everyone an enriching and inspiring Hult Prize experience and hope this initiative becomes a stepping stone towards creating the changemakers and entrepreneurs of tomorrow.

IIC Convenor, University of Calcutta

convenor.iic-cu@caluniv.ac.in
rgaphy@caluniv.ac.in

Dr. Sharmistha Banerjee

It is my great pleasure to welcome all participants to the Hult Prize, a platform that celebrates innovation, entrepreneurship, and the power of young minds to create meaningful change.

The Hult Prize provides students with an opportunity to move beyond ideas and take the first steps towards building solutions for real-world challenges. It encourages creativity, teamwork, leadership, and a strong sense of social responsibility.

I encourage all participants to make the most of this experience—to think boldly, collaborate openly, learn from every challenge, and believe in the potential of their ideas. Your journey through the Hult Prize is not just about competition; it is about discovering possibilities, developing confidence, and creating an impact that extends beyond the campus.

Campus Co-ordinator Hult Prize of Alipore Campus, University of Calcutta

sharmisthabanerjee@hotmail.com

ORGANISING TEAM MEMBERS

Team Registration & Participation Coordination

Bazilur Rahman Bazigh

Judge & Mentor Coordination

Saheli Chatterjee

Ground Operation & Volunteering Management

Toufik Jamal Mondal

Shreya Gupta

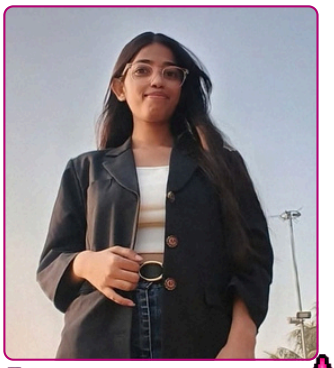
Technical & Web Team

Rajdeep Sarkar

Jinea Saha

ORGANISING TEAM MEMBERS

Design Creative & Documentation



Shivani Singh

Siddhi Kumari

Mrittika Rudra

Rachit Vats

Business Partnership & Sponsorship

Bhavita Rai

Angellena Basu

Suvam Kar

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ORGANISING TEAM MEMBERS

Marketing, PR & Communication

Anukta Goswami

Shreyashi Bera

Soham Ray

Pritam Dey

CAMPUS DIRECTORS

2025-26
Srijita Mandal
(B.Tech in Polymer Science & Technology, Department of Applied Chemistry)

2024-25
Ankit Sarkar
(B.Tech in Instrumentation Engineering, Department of Applied Physics)

2023-24
Abhisek Chowdhury
(B.Tech in Instrumentation Engineering, Department of Applied Physics)

2022-23
AyanMullick
(B.Tech in Polymer Science & Technology, Department of Applied Chemistry)

2021-22
SayakSengupta
(B.Tech in Polymer Science & Technology, Department of Applied Chemistry)

2020-21
Ridipt Mishra
(B.Tech in Chemical Technology, Department of Applied Chemistry)

PREVIOUS YEAR WINNERS

2025-26 Winners

TEAM : IGNITIA

2024-25 Winners

TEAM : SENSERIOUS

2023-24 Winners

TEAM : QUIZZITIVE

PREVIOUS YEAR(S) SPONSORS

The Telegraph online edugraph

ASYMPTOTE

IEEE Student Branch University of Calcutta

Cane CRUSH

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CONTACT DETAILS

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